

Guinea Pig Body Signals



What their body and mood are telling you

Body condition, at a glance

Too thin

Spine/hips easily felt, no fat cover

Ideal

Ribs felt with slight fat cover, rounded body

Overweight

Ribs hard to feel, no waist definition

Reading the signals

Happy looks like

- ♥ Popcorning (a happy little hop)
- ♥ Soft purring/rumbling while being petted
- ♥ Lying stretched out and relaxed
- ♥ Approaching you at the sound of your voice

Stressed looks like

- ♥ Freezing completely still
- ♥ Teeth chattering or loud squeaking
- ♥ Hiding and refusing to come out
- ♥ Fur standing up along the back

A few enrichment ideas

- ♥ A cardboard tunnel gives them a safe route to dash through and explore, which they love
- ♥ Hiding veggie pieces in their hay encourages natural foraging instead of just handing food over
- ♥ A new hideout to investigate adds welcome variety to an otherwise familiar space
- ♥ Gentle lap time on a towel builds trust through calm, low-pressure handling



Guinea Pig Must-Knows



1

Hay should be about 80% of their diet, available 24/7

2

Never feed onions/garlic (damage red blood cells) or avocado (toxic compound called persin)

3

Cage: at least 7.5 sq ft for one guinea pig, or 10.5+ sq ft for a bonded pair

4

Not eating for 6+ hours can signal GI stasis (their gut slows or stops, letting gas build up dangerously) — call the vet

5

They're highly social — most guinea pigs do best with a bonded companion

Bonus fun fact

Guinea pigs aren't pigs, and they're not from Guinea — they're originally from the Andes region of South America.

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The Guinea Pig Parent Guide, Sitter Kit & Journal go way deeper — checklists, trackers, keepsakes & more, made just for your guinea pig.

[See the full collection at georgiekins.com](https://georgiekins.com)



Guinea Pig Emergency & Prep



What to watch for, and how to get ready

Call the vet if you see

- ♥ Not eating hay or produce for 6+ hours — can signal GI stasis (their digestive system slows or stops, letting gas and bacteria build up dangerously fast), a real emergency
- ♥ Few or no droppings, or unusually small/dry ones
- ♥ Sneezing, discharge, or noisy breathing (respiratory infections are common)
- ♥ Hunched posture, teeth grinding, or drooling (overgrown teeth or pain)

If something risky gets eaten

Call your vet or the ASPCA Animal Poison Control Center:
(888) 426-4435 — available 24/7

